CELPIP EXPRESS

Listening Test

STUDY MATERIALS - 2

PART 1

Listening to Problem Solving

Question 1 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ◯ Her family doctor's office is closed.
- ◯ She is returning for a follow-up visit.
- ◯ It was recommended by a friend.
- ◯ She doesn't have a family doctor.

Question 2 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

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Question 3 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ◯ a pen
- ◯ her appointment card
- ◯ a health card
- ◯ her doctor's name

Question 4 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ◯ lend him a pen
- ◯ fill out some paperwork
- ◯ apply for a health card
- ◯ ask questions if needed

Question 5 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ◯ surprised
- ◯ upset
- ◯ worried
- ◯ confused

Question 6 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- ◯ annoyed
- ◯ worried
- ◯ happy
- ◯ satisfied

Question 7 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- ◯ The waiting room is quite crowded.
- ◯ The doctor is a popular specialist.
- ◯ There is only one doctor at the clinic.
- ◯ There are many sick people at this time of year.

Question 8 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- ◯ go to another clinic
- ◯ wait to see the doctor
- ◯ come back another day
- ◯ step out for some food

PART 2

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

Question 1 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ The woman extends an invitation to the man.
- ◯ The man questions the woman about gardening.
- ◯ The woman wants to meet the man's grandmother.
- ◯ The man asks the woman about making jam.

Question 2 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ nursing homes
- ◯ pick-your-own farms
- ◯ directions to Carter Road
- ◯ strawberry jam recipe

Question 3 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ It is closer than the other one.
- ◯ It has a playground.
- ◯ The baskets are free.
- ◯ The strawberries are better.

Question 4 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ They are always far from the city centre.
- ◯ They usually have special areas for children.
- ◯ Their fruit is not necessarily free of chemicals.
- ◯ Their fruit is cheaper than grocery store fruit.

Question 5 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ meeting Andy's grandmother
- ◯ picking strawberries
- ◯ playing with children
- ◯ making strawberry jam

PART 3

Listening for Information

Question 1 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ to get legal advice for renters
- ◯ to inquire about an apartment
- ◯ to get in touch with her landlord
- ◯ to review her lease agreement

Question 2 of 6: Choose the best answer

- ◯ It was included in the rental contract.
- ◯ It was sent to the wrong rental board.
- ◯ She did not receive a receipt for it.
- ◯ The landlord collected too much money.

Question 3 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ ask for a receipt
- ◯ cancel the last month
- ◯ continue to pay it
- ◯ pay by cheque

Question 4 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ cancel her damage deposit cheque
- ◯ contact the provincial rental board
- ◯ take her landlord to court
- ◯ write a formal letter to her landlord

Question 5 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ 6% of the claim
- ◯ $70
- ◯ $1000
- ◯ nothing

Question 6 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ by email
- ◯ by mail
- ◯ by telephone
- ◯ in person

PART 4

Listening to a News Item

1. Shauna _____
- ◯ enjoys shopping in bargain stores.
- ◯ enjoys shopping in jewelry stores.
- ◯ works in a jewelry store.
- ◯ works in a bargain store.

2. She learned of the rings' possible value from _____
- ◯ a jewel expert.
- ◯ an online magazine.
- ◯ her mother.
- ◯ the bargain store.

3. Shauna tested for genuine amber by _____
- ◯ comparing the rings to real amber.
- ◯ looking for fossil marks in the amber.
- ◯ polishing the rings to reveal the amber.
- ◯ rubbing the amber to attract dust.

4. Others did NOT know the rings' value because _____
- ◯ the amber looked like plain glass.
- ◯ the amber was an unusual colour.
- ◯ the price for the rings was very low.
- ◯ the thrift store did not have a jeweler.

5. Shauna decided to _____
- ◯ ask a jeweler to help her sell the rings.
- ◯ give two of the rings to her mother.
- ◯ keep the rings for the future.
- ◯ sell the rings and travel abroad.

PART 5

Listening to a Discussion

1. Primarily, what did the co-workers meet to discuss?
- ◯ what to do about an unfair salary scale
- ◯ what suggestions to bring to HR management
- ◯ how to respond to an unpopular policy
- ◯ how to balance work with outside interests

2. According to the workers, how did the managers show favouritism?
- ◯ hiring whatever personality they liked the best
- ◯ providing more paid vacation days to some employees
- ◯ granting longer breaks for some employees
- ◯ choosing which workers would get a raise in salary

3. What was HR's opinion on the matter being discussed?
- ◯ Managers are skilled at choosing the best person.
- ◯ The workers should consult the legal department.
- ◯ Most employees are busy with their own work.
- ◯ The quality of the result is good on most projects.

4. Why was the woman, Claudia, unable to attend the conference?
- ◯ The manager had funding for only two delegates.
- ◯ The manager said she was not qualified.
- ◯ She doesn't have free time from work.
- ◯ She isn't one of the manager's favourites.

5. What do these three employees want from their jobs?
- ◯ consultation on corporate policy revisions
- ◯ promotion to positions paying higher wages
- ◯ recognition for producing quality results
- ◯ selection for free skills training programs

6. How does the discussion end?
- ◯ They decide to work harder at their jobs.
- ◯ They plan to complain to HR together.
- ◯ They realize they can't change the policy.
- ◯ They will inform others about favouritism.

PART 5

7. Why does Claudia help out at her son's school?

- ◯ Her son has learning difficulties.
- ◯ She feels good about helping out.
- ◯ She has lots of free time.
- ◯ The school asked her to volunteer.

8. What will these employees probably do after this meeting?

- ◯ ask for a reasonable promotion and wage increase
- ◯ distract themselves with activities elsewhere
- ◯ research current laws regarding organized labour
- ◯ seek more rewarding work with a better company

PART 6

Listening for Viewpoints

1. The presentation is mainly about the _____

- ◯ cost of getting an education.
- ◯ value of the humanities.
- ◯ nature of career training.
- ◯ popularity of a university education.

2. The presentation implies that accounting and engineering students _____

- ◯ are likely to find employment in their fields.
- ◯ have harder courses than humanities students.
- ◯ are surprisingly overqualified for their first jobs.
- ◯ pay higher tuition fees than humanities students.

3. It is implied that humanities graduates _____

- ◯ are actually more job-ready than career-program grads.
- ◯ help their employers to become more profitable.
- ◯ are more reliable than career-program graduates.
- ◯ help to uphold modern democratic societies.

4. The author seems to agree that employers are looking for _____

- ◯ a broader range of critical-thinking skills.
- ◯ employees who respect hierarchy.
- ◯ a new code of ethics for the workplace.
- ◯ workers who passively accept policies.

5. According to the presentation, humanities courses _____

- ◯ are increasingly relevant in the modern workplace.
- ◯ lead to having some of the skills employers want.
- ◯ are required in many university career programs.
- ◯ lead to jobs that pay only the minimum wage.

6. The author would likely support _____

- ◯ attending trade school rather than university.
- ◯ eliminating some university humanities courses.
- ◯ including critical-thinking skills across all subjects.
- ◯ giving student loans only to career-program students.

Answer Key

PART 1	
Question 1	She doesn't have a family doctor.
Question 2	
Question 3	a health card
Question 4	fill out some paperwork
Question 5	surprised
Question 6	annoyed
Question 7	There are many sick people at this time of year.
Question 8	wait to see the doctor

PART 2	
Question 1	The woman extends an invitation to the man.
Question 2	pick-your-own farms
Question 3	The strawberries are better.
Question 4	Their fruit is not necessarily free of chemicals.
Question 5	meeting Andy's grandmother

PART 3	
Question 1	to get legal advice for renters
Question 2	The landlord collected too much money.
Question 3	continue to pay it
Question 4	write a formal letter to her landlord
Question 5	nothing
Question 6	by mail

PART 4	
Question 1	enjoys shopping in bargain stores.
Question 2	her mother.
Question 3	rubbing the amber to attract dust.
Question 4	the amber looked like plain glass.
Question 5	sell the rings and travel abroad.

PART 5	
Question 1	how to respond to an unpopular policy
Question 2	choosing which workers would get a raise in salary
Question 3	Managers are skilled at choosing the best person.
Question 4	She isn't one of the manager's favourites.
Question 5	recognition for producing quality results
Question 6	They realize they can't change the policy.
Question 7	She feels good about helping out.
Question 8	distract themselves with activities elsewhere

PART 6	
Question 1	value of the humanities.
Question 2	are likely to find employment in their fields.
Question 3	help to uphold modern democratic societies.
Question 4	workers who passively accept policies.
Question 5	lead to having some of the skills employers want.
Question 6	including critical-thinking skills across all subjects.

Transcripts

Listening to Problem Solving

You will hear a conversation between a man and a woman. The man is an assistant at a medical clinic, and the woman wants to see a doctor.

Section 1:

WOMAN: Hi. I was hoping you could help me. I've never been to this walk-in clinic before. I moved here a few months ago, and I still don't have a family doctor, but I really need to see one right away.

MAN: Sorry, but you'll have to take a number and wait to be called. There are a couple people ahead of you. It shouldn't be too long, though.

WOMAN: Oh, sorry! I didn't realize I had to take a number. I assumed that since no one was at the counter when I came in, I could just walk up. Where are the number tickets?

MAN: Yeah, it happens all the time. The numbers are just to the left of the door, in the red dispenser. Like I said, it won't be long. In the meantime, you can take a seat.

Now answer questions 1-2.

1. Why is the woman at this clinic?
2. What does the woman need?

Section 2:

MAN: Number 47 please!

WOMAN: Hi, I'm back. I'd like to see a doctor, please. I've been having sharp pains in my stomach for over a week now.

MAN: Okay, I'll just need to see your provincial health card please . . . And since we don't have your information on file, I'm going to need you to fill out this patient information form.

WOMAN: Sure. Oh darn, I don't have a pen. Do you have one I could borrow?

MAN: Yes, here you are. Please bring the form and pen back up when you're done.

WOMAN: Thank you. Oh wow! There are certainly a lot of questions here!

MAN: You only need to fill it out for your first appointment and then we keep it on file. You can go and sit down and complete the form. It'll only take a few minutes.

WOMAN: Will it ever!

Now answer questions 3-5.

3. What does the man ask the woman for?
4. What does the man ask the woman to do?
5. How does the woman feel about the form?

Transcripts

Section 3:

WOMAN: Okay, I filled out all the information I could. I don't really know my family's history of illnesses, so I just left that section blank.

MAN: That's all right. Oh, I see you missed this section on the back of the page—the one about your allergies and medications.

WOMAN: Oops, I didn't realize it was two-sided. Here you go. Do you know how long the wait will be?

MAN: Well, it's hard to say exactly. But at this point, it's looking like at least one hour.

WOMAN: One hour! Seriously? This waiting room is practically empty!

MAN: Well, it is flu season. And sometimes people step out for a bit while they're waiting. There are quite a few names ahead of yours, and only two doctors on duty.

WOMAN: Well, I guess I don't really have a choice. Let's hope some of the people who have stepped out just decided to leave.

Now answer questions 6-8.

6. How does the woman feel about the wait time?
7. Why is the wait to see a doctor so long?
8. What does the woman decide to do at the end?

Transcripts

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

You are about to hear a conversation between two people, a man and a woman, who are friends.

WOMAN: Hi Andy, how are you? I was wondering . . . do you have any plans for tomorrow?

MAN: Not in the morning, no. But in the afternoon, I was going to visit my grandmother at the nursing home. We spend some time together every Saturday.

WOMAN: Oh, I hope she's not ill. You're such a thoughtful grandson!

MAN: I suppose, but I don't do it to be kind or anything. I genuinely enjoy spending time with her. She's an amazing person.

WOMAN: Then I'd like to meet her some time! Well, since you don't have plans for the morning, would you like to come with me to pick strawberries? There are two 'pick your own' farms nearby, but I go to the one on Carter Road because it has the best strawberries.

MAN: What, exactly, is a 'pick your own' farm?

WOMAN: It's exactly what it says! You go to the farm and buy an empty basket, unless you have your own. Then they take you out into the field, show you which row is ready to be picked next, and you just make your way along the row, filling your basket. When you've got as much as you want, you go back, they weigh what you have, and you pay.

MAN: What an excellent idea! I imagine the fruit is cheaper when you pick your own?

WOMAN: Usually, but not always. The same goes for the health factor. I incorrectly assumed that none of the 'pick your own' farms used pesticides. Now I know, I only go to the farm on Carter Road.

MAN: Ah. I'll bet people who make their own strawberry jam get their strawberries at 'pick your own' farms, if only because they'd be fresh.

WOMAN: That's certainly true! Often they take their kids and make a day of it. Some farms even have a play area for the kids.

MAN: Okay, let's do it! We can take some fresh strawberries to my grandmother in the afternoon! I'll introduce you!

Now answer questions 1-5.

1. What is the **main** purpose of the conversation?
2. What does the woman describe to the man?
3. Why does the woman prefer the farm on Carter Road?
4. What is true of pick-your-own farms?
5. What will the woman likely be doing Saturday afternoon?

Transcripts

Listening for Information

You are about to hear a conversation between a man and a woman.

MAN: Welcome to the Renters' Legal Clinic. What brings you here?

WOMAN: Well, when I signed the lease to rent my apartment, my landlord made me pay extra, and I want that money back.

MAN: What fees did the landlord charge you, apart from the first month's rent?

WOMAN: Well, the rent is $1,000 a month. In addition to that, he collected an equal amount for a "damage deposit," which he said he'd repay at the end of the lease if the apartment was left in good condition. But what if he finds some excuse not to pay it back?

MAN: Exactly. It's illegal for landlords to collect damage deposits that are more than half a month's rent in this province. The landlord should know that. It says so right in the lease agreement. Did you read that part of the contract before you signed it?

WOMAN: No! He rushed through and turned that page really fast, so I didn't even see where it said that! But can I just not pay the rent for the final month of the lease? The rent is $1,000 a month, so not paying for the last month would be the same as him refunding my deposit, right?

MAN: Mmm, I wouldn't recommend withholding rent money because then your landlord might come after you for nonpayment. What you should do is write a letter to your landlord requesting that half of the deposit be returned to you.

WOMAN: Ah, so it's better to be on the offensive?

MAN: Right. I'll dictate a letter for you to type and sign. The letter warns the landlord that the money was collected illegally and demands that if he doesn't repay it to you in ten days, you'll appeal to the Rental Board to recover the money. In that case, there'll be a hearing in court, and the government will collect the money for you.

WOMAN: Do I have to pay a lawyer?

MAN: Not me—I volunteer my time. You pay the Rental Board. It costs $70 to file a claim—if that becomes necessary. But you'll get that money back. The landlord will have to pay your deposit, plus the $70 and 6% interest.

WOMAN: Sounds fair.

MAN: Just be sure you send the letter by Registered Mail. That way you can track the delivery online and know whether or not he actually received it.

WOMAN: Okay, let's get started.

Now answer questions 1-6.

1. Why did the woman go see the man?
2. What was the problem with the woman's damage deposit?
3. What does the man say the woman should do about her rent?
4. What step will the woman take next?
5. What does the man charge for his services?
6. How should the woman make her request?

Transcripts

Listening to a News Item

You will hear a news story about a ring purchase.

Seventeen year old Shauna Bergman made over $1000 this weekend because of her love of thrift store shopping. Bergman was browsing second hand jewelry at her local thrift store on Friday when she found five silver rings with what looked like different shapes of pretty glass set on the top. Shauna bought the set for ten dollars, thinking she'd give them as gifts. When she returned home, however, her mother suggested the stones might not actually be glass but amber. Amber is fossilized resin from trees that are millions of years old. Shauna did some research on how to recognize genuine amber from fake amber. If real amber is rubbed vigorously on fabric, it becomes electrostatically charged and will visibly attract dust particles. Shauna discovered she'd bought six real amber rings. Because the amber had been melted and pressed, it looked like man-made glass. However, a local jeweler confirmed her conclusion, appraised them to be amber and offered her a handsome price. Shauna decided to use the proceeds to finance a trip to Peru.

Transcripts

Listening to a Discussion

You will watch a conversation among three employees. Two men and one woman in a coffee shop. They are discussing something they've noticed in their workplace.

Nick: Hey guys. Thanks for coming for coffee this morning.

Ron: No problem. It's been a while since we got together. We should do this more often!

Claudia: Yeah. It's really nice to get out of the office once in a while. We work too hard and ignore our breaks!

Nick: True enough. Actually, the reason I got us all together was there's something I wanted to run by the two of you, something that's been bothering me. It has to do with how devoted we are to our jobs.

Claudia: Hmmm, you've got me curious. Are you going to suggest that we get raises because of our dedication? Good luck with that!

Ron: Hey, some people got raises last year, just not everyone. Didn't you hear about that?

Nick: Yeah, this is actually all connected to what I wanted to talk to you guys about. I've been noticing a lot of favouritism lately.

Claudia: I agree. Just last week the boss hand-picked two of her favourites to go to the programming conference in Montreal. The same two went last year! I mean, what about the rest of us? I'm more qualified; I even asked if I could pay my own conference fees, and just get paid for two days' work. She still refused.

Ron: Well, we call it favouritism but, according to company policy, it's perfectly legal. Managers can select anyone they want for any project, even if there's extra pay or benefits, as long as the length is not more than six months. And managers can pick the same person every time.

Nick: But this policy fosters favouritism! I mean, the managers have no accountability for the decisions they make, and the decisions rarely reflect the quality of work. I had to do some revisions for one of the favourites just last week even though I was completely busy with my own work—I didn't get any extra pay. Her work was terrible. Maybe we should start a workers' union.

Claudia: Well, I don't think a union is the solution. I mean, it may reduce favouritism, but it can produce a whole other set of problems. I think our communication with management is pretty good overall.

Ron: Yeah. I took a risk and talked to the HR manager —he said everything is legal, and that managers would make the best choice.

Nick: So I guess we just have to deal with favouritism then? I mean, we might as well just focus our passion and enthusiasm outside the workplace. We can collect our salary and put our heart and souls into something else.

Claudia: Actually, that's what I do. I tutor kids that have difficulty reading at my son's school. It's really rewarding. Maybe we could freelance, too, add a little money to that satisfaction.

Ron: So I guess it's decided then. To cope with all this favouritism, we are going to focus our energy outside the workplace. I mean, it's a sad solution, but I guess it's going to be the safest one.

Transcripts

Listening for Viewpoints

You will hear a presentation about a current issue in Canadian universities.

The humanities are a group of academic disciplines that focus on human culture, including subjects like literature, history, and philosophy. A recent Statistics Canada report indicates that 30% of university graduates with a humanities degree are overqualified for the jobs they hold. Many don't even have jobs. Does this mean that students shouldn't study the humanities—and universities shouldn't bother offering humanities degrees?

If the purpose of universities is to provide career training, then at a glance the future looks grim for the humanities. After all, university is expensive. Many students—along with their tuition-fee-paying parents—expect to eventually receive a reasonable return on their investment. Such students should probably study accounting and engineering instead of literature and philosophy. But this raises the question, "What is the purpose of university?"

Many would argue that universities exist in order to provide a broad education, not job training. That education, they'd argue, should include the humanities. Traditionally, the humanities help produce a citizenry that can distinguish between fact and propaganda, a citizenry not susceptible to the manipulative rhetoric of potential demagogues. However, not everyone considers this outcome desirable—because such a populace is cognitively well-equipped to question the distribution of power and hence potentially disrupt the status quo.

Even if it is the purpose of the university to make students job-ready, it appears that employers still want their workers to have good critical thinking skills. These skills are learned in the humanities. Most philosophy departments, for example, offer a course in critical thinking skills. They also teach ethics, a branch of philosophy that enables people to make reasoned decisions about right and wrong.

And yet, how often do we see an entry-level job ad mentioning a philosophy course as a requirement? Still, when surveyed, today's employers say they want new hires to have critical thinking skills. However, entry-level workers say that their employers want them to think critically only about certain things. Critical thinking about cost-cutting? Probably. Critical thinking about policies and procedures? Probably not. And as for ethics—workers report that their employers want compliance with the company's code of ethics.

Employers seem to want it both ways: workers who are job ready and who think critically; workers who think critically about some things but not all things. It seems employers want to have their cake and eat it, too—which is, to many critical thinkers, a logical impossibility. Perhaps in the end it is the employers who need the humanities courses.